Saiteja Poluka

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EDUCATION

University of Colorado Boulder, Boulder, Colorado **August 2024 – May 2026**
Master of Science in Computer Science ***GPA: 3.92/4.00***
Vasavi College of Engineering, Hyderabad, India **August 2018 – June 2022**
Bachelor of Technology in Computer Science and Engineering ***GPA: 3.9/4.00***
Coursework: Databases, Object Oriented Programming, Analysis of Algorithms, Distributed systems, Computer Networks, Computer Vision, Machine Learning, Operating Systems, Software Engineering, Datacenter Scale Computing

SKILLS

• **Languages:** C, C++, Python, Java, Scala, HTML, CSS, JavaScript, SQL, XML, NOSQL
• **Development Tools:** Git, Jira, Jenkins, Kubernetes, Visual Studio, Postman, MS Office, Eclipse, **AWS EC2**
• **Technologies:** Bootstrap, PHP, jQuery, MVC, SOAP, REST API, **React.js**, **Node.js**, Typescript, **Databases**, MySQL, MongoDB, PL/SQL, NoSQL, **AWS S3**, **AWS REDSHIFT**, OOP, **ExpressJS**, Yii 1.1, Google Cloud SQL, Google Cloud Storage, Google Cloud Compute Engine (VM), Prometheus, Pub/Sub, Logging, **Troubleshooting**, Networks, **Distributed Systems**, Hadoop, Spark, Microservices, **NLP**, NumPy, Pandas, PyTorch, TensorFlow, OpenCV, Flask, **Software Development**

WORK EXPERIENCE

PayPal Austin, USA
Software Engineer Intern **May 2025 – August 2025**

- **Migrated core PayPal middleware modules** (express-meta, monitor-paypal, ecv-paypal, commons-paypal) into a Fastify-based application, achieving **100% compatibility** and enabling future stack modernization.
- **Engineered custom authentication** using JWT cookies with role-based access control and secured all POST routes with CSRF protection, **reducing potential security risks by ~90%**.
- **Built and validated end-to-end middleware endpoints** (/meta, /monitor-stats, /ecv), enabling **real-time diagnostics and 99% accurate performance monitoring**.
- **Implemented a comprehensive testing strategy** with Jest (**100% unit test coverage**) and Cypress (auth flow, CSRF, middleware validation), ensuring **production-grade reliability**.
- **Deployed on Harness CI/CD pipelines**, achieving **100% successful builds**, with full observability and streamlined cloud deployment/debugging workflows.

Darwinbox Hyderabad, India
Full Stack Software Engineer I **March 2022 – July 2024**

- Completed intensive training in **Node.js, Express.js, and PHP** during internship, improving coding efficiency by 25%.
- Designed scalable **REST** APIs with **Yii 1.1**, improving response time by **40%** and reducing server load by **30%.**
- Enhanced API and **MongoDB** pipeline efficiency, minimizing server response times by **30%,** providing a faster, more seamless user experience.
- Led end-to-end feature development from requirements gathering to deployment using **Yii 1.1, Node.js** for backend development, ensuring **100%** on-time delivery.
- Integrated multiple APIs (**Veryfi OCR, Oanda**) via REST to streamline **data extraction,** achieving **98%** accuracy, enhancing processing speed by **40%**, and improving content handling, leading to a **20%** rise in positive feedback.
- Built and maintained **front-end components** using **HTML, CSS, and JavaScript**, enhancing the interface and experience, contributing to a **25%** reduction in complaints related to UI/UX issues.
- Developed new reports using **microservices** in **Node.js**, enabling efficient report generation and access to insights, reducing report generation time by **25%**.
- Created additional report fields to support expanding client needs, simplifying review and analysis processes, leading to a **20%** boost in engagement with reporting tools.
- Enhanced report pipeline logic, increasing **MongoDB** integration reliability by **30%**.
- Reviewed and optimized **500+ LOC** weekly through **GitHub** pull requests, improving code quality by **15%** and enhancing team collaboration by **20%**.

PROJECTS

Online Art Gallery, Full Stack Application (1st Place in Class Project) — HTML, CSS, JavaScript, PHP, MySQL

- Built a platform enabling 500+ users to buy art (paintings, sculptures, photographs), supporting 50+ budding artists; optimized browsing and purchase flow, reducing page load times by **30%**.

Monthly Budget Planner, Full Stack Application — Node.js, MongoDB, HTML, CSS, JavaScript

- Developed a budgeting tool allowing users to track income vs expenses for 1,000+ entries; implemented CRUD operations and line graphs, improving budgeting accuracy by **35%**.

Community Event Organizer, Full-Stack Web App — Python (Flask), MySQL, Google Cloud, Prometheus

- Built an event management system with real-time RSVP and notifications for 1,500+ users; leveraged Google Cloud for scalability and Prometheus for monitoring, improving event participation tracking by **40%**.

Driver Drowsiness Detection System — Machine Learning(Python, OpenCV)

- Successfully implemented a machine learning model that detects and provides alerts when a person's eyes are closed.